

ProACT Adjustable Balloons (for Men)

Patient Information · Two adjustable balloons that support the urethra after prostate surgery

WARWIKI

ProACT is a small implant for men who leak urine after prostate surgery. Two tiny balloons sit on either side of the urethra, just below the bladder, to help it close. The balloons can be **adjusted in the office** after surgery until the balance is right.

How It Works

After prostate surgery, the muscle that holds urine in can be weak. The balloons press gently on the **bladder neck** so the urethra closes better when you cough, lift or move. They do not squeeze it shut. Each balloon connects to a small **port** under the skin of the scrotum. Your team uses the port to add or remove fluid.

Benefits and Risks in Numbers

5–6 in 10

men are dry or use just 1 safety pad a day

about
1 in 4

have the balloons taken out at some point

2–3 in 10

need another operation

Numbers are averages from published studies. Your own risk may differ; ask your team.

Is It Right for Me?

- In the United States, it is approved for men who still leak **12 months or more** after prostate surgery, despite other treatment.
- It is **not advised after pelvic radiation**. Success is lower and the balloons are more likely to wear into tissue.
- It works less well for heavy leakage.
- It may be one step: some men later choose an artificial urinary sphincter (AUS).

Learn the Terms

Stress incontinence

Leaking urine when you cough, lift or exercise.

Urethra

The tube that carries urine out of the body.

Bladder neck

Where the bladder meets the urethra.

Balloon

A small silicone balloon that adds gentle support.

Port

A tiny valve under the skin of the scrotum used to adjust a balloon.

Adjustment

Adding or removing a little fluid at an office visit.

AUS

Artificial urinary sphincter, a different implant with a cuff and pump.

Will it hurt? The balloons are placed during a short operation, usually under general or spinal anesthesia, through small cuts. You may be sore and swollen for a few days. The later office adjustments are quick and use a small needle at the port.

First days

Mild soreness and swelling. You may need a catheter briefly.

First 6 weeks

The balloons heal in place. No adjustments yet.

After 6 weeks

Office adjustments, about every 4 weeks, as needed.

Later

Adjust up or down if leakage changes.

How It's Done

- 1 Using X-ray or a scope to guide them, the surgeon places one balloon on each side of the urethra at the bladder neck.
- 2 The tubes are run to two ports under the skin of the scrotum.
- 3 The balloons start with only a little fluid. You should be able to urinate before you go home. If not, a catheter is used for a short time.

Adjusting the Balloons

- No adjustments are made for about **6 weeks**. After that, your team can add a little fluid through the port in the office. There is no surgery.
- This may be repeated about every 4 weeks until you have good control and can still empty well.
- Leakage improves **gradually**, not always right away.
- Fluid can be removed if you have trouble urinating. The balloons can be taken out if needed.

Call the office that did your surgery if you have:

- A temperature of **100.4 °F (38 °C)** or higher, or chills
- Pain, redness or fluid leaking at a cut or the port
- A weak stream, blood in your urine, or leakage that suddenly returns

Go to an emergency department if:

- You cannot urinate for several hours and your bladder feels full or painful
- You cannot reach the office and are worried

Three Things to Remember

1. ProACT uses two balloons to help the urethra close after prostate surgery.
2. Adjustments start after about 6 weeks and may take several visits.
3. Tell any future surgeon or imaging team that you have the implant.